

6.2 The Genre Calibration Reference Chart

6.2.1 The Five Subgenre Profiles

Locate your subgenre below. The three calibration parameters—Emotional Intensity Range, Subtext Density Level, and Pacing Curve—govern how your Three-Tier Emotional Filter delivers its content for your specific readership.

Contemporary Romance

Parameter	Calibration
Emotional Intensity Range	Moderate, warm, with controlled spikes during conflict scenes.
Subtext Density Level	Medium. The subtext becomes visible to the reader within two to three exchanges.
Pacing Curve	Steady. Emotional beats land every four to six lines. A release or shift occurs within the scene.

Dark Romance

Parameter	Calibration
Emotional Intensity Range	High to volatile. Sustained tension with sharp spikes during confrontation.
Subtext Density Level	Heavy. The subtext remains partially hidden for five to eight exchanges. The reader senses the weight without seeing it clearly.
Pacing Curve	Slow burn with sudden acceleration. Emotional beats build over eight to twelve lines before a sharp turn or crack.

Rom-Com

Parameter	Calibration
Emotional Intensity Range	Light to moderate. Comedic deflection manages the emotional charge.
Subtext Density Level	Light to medium. The subtext is visible and playful rather than heavy or punishing.

Parameter	Calibration
Pacing Curve	Rapid-fire. Emotional beats land every two to three lines. Deflections and recoveries cycle quickly. The emotional truth surfaces in brief, sharp moments between the humor.

Romantic Suspense

Parameter	Calibration
Emotional Intensity Range	Moderate to high. External danger modulates the emotional register.
Subtext Density Level	Medium to heavy. Trust and suspicion layer every exchange.
Pacing Curve	Uneven. Emotional beats are interrupted by plot pressure, creating a push-pull rhythm that keeps the reader off-balance.

Historical Romance

Parameter	Calibration
Emotional Intensity Range	Moderate. Formality and social constraint compress the emotional expression.
Subtext Density Level	Heavy. Propriety and restraint force the subtext to carry most of the emotional weight.
Pacing Curve	Slow burn. Emotional beats build over six to ten lines. The release is delayed by social convention. The tension is sustained by what cannot be said aloud.

6.2.2 Genre Calibration Record Worksheet

Record your subgenre's three parameters below. These values become the modifiers you add to your Three-Tier Emotional Filter before every generation pass.

Subgenre: [YOUR_SUBGENRE]

Date: [DATE]

Parameter	Calibration Setting (copy from chart)	How This Modifies My Filter
Emotional Intensity	[COPY_FROM_CHART]	[E.G., "I will adjust my Emotional Default tier to allow higher volatility during

Parameter	Calibration Setting (copy from chart)	How This Modifies My Filter
Range		confrontation scenes."]
Subtext Density Level	[COPY_FROM_CHART]	[E.G., "I will ensure my Subtext Layer keeps the felt emotion partially hidden for at least five exchanges."]
Pacing Curve	[COPY_FROM_CHART]	[E.G., "I will add a progression clause to my Trigger Response tier specifying an eight-to-twelve-line build before the crack."]